How-To Library

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Anonymize data in MDM SaaS

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Abstract

This article helps you use Business 360 REST APIs to anonymize data by obfuscating field values identified as personally identifiable information (PII) in source records associated with master records and the history of master records.

Supported Versions

- May 2025 or later

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Introduction

Use Business 360 REST APIs to anonymize data by obfuscating personally identifiable information (PII) in source records. When you perform data anonymization, you anonymize the PII data in source records and the history of master records. This irreversible process ensures that PII is transformed into anonymous data in all relevant source and master records.

To anonymize data, identify master records and their associated source records that contain PII. If multiple source records contribute values to a master record, repeat this process for each source record. These changes are irreversible.

To anonymize data, perform the following steps:

1. Identify the PII that needs to be obfuscated.
2. Identify a master record and its associated source records that contain PII.
3. Unmerge the source records from the master record, and delete relationships and relevant patch records associated with the master record.
4. Anonymize the source record.
5. Anonymize the history of the master record.

Guidelines to anonymize data

Consider the following guidelines when you anonymize PII data:

- Update a unique anonymous value that isn't similar to any other field value to prevent anonymized source records from matching with other records.
- Ensure anonymized field values comply with the data type and format. For example, if the field is a picklist, ensure that the anonymized reference data values are available.
- When you create a business event, the cache data is retained in the MDM SaaS data store. Ensure that you modify the **Expire In** event detail of a publishing event based on your requirements so that PII isn't retained in the data store. For more information about publishing events, see *Define Business Events*.

Step 1: Identify the PII

Identify the PII, such as first name, last name, full name, address, and birth date. The identified PII needs to be obfuscated for anonymizing the record.

Before you anonymize data, perform the following tasks:

1. Identify master records and their associated source records that contain the PII.
2. Ensure that all approval workflows and changes that impact the master records are complete.
3. Ensure that no jobs are running for the master records.

Step 2: Retrieve a source record associated with a master record

Retrieve a source record that contains the PII using the Read Source Record API.

To retrieve a source record, submit a GET request with the following URI:

```
GET <baseApiURL>/business-entity/public/api/v1/entity-xref/<businessEntity>/<sourceSystem>/
<sourcePKey>[&_resolveCrosswalk=true|false]
```

The GET request contains the following parameters:

Parameter	Description
businessEntity	Internal ID of the business entity for which you want to retrieve the source record.
sourceSystem	Internal ID of the source system to which the record belongs.
sourcePKey	The primary key of the source record.
_resolveCrosswalk	Indicates whether to standardize picklist values based on the source system configuration. Set to true to standardize the picklist values. When you specify this parameter, you must set the sourceSystem parameter. Default is false. For more information about standardizing picklist values, see *Define Source Systems*.

The response is in the JSON format. The response body contains the source record data.

The GET response includes `_meta` parameters and an object that contains data enrichment and validation details:

Parameter	Type	Description
businessId	String	Unique identifier of the source record.
id	String	Unique identifier of the business entity record. Don't use.
businessEntity	String	Internal ID of the business entity from which you retrieved the source record.
createdBy	String	Name of the user who created the record.
creationDate	String	Date when the record was created.
updatedBy	String	Name of the user who last updated the record.
lastUpdateDate	String	Date when the master record was last updated.
sourceLastUpdatedDate	String	Date when the source record was last updated.

Parameter	Type	Description
states	String	The different statuses of an active source record. Source records can have one of the following statuses: - base. The current status of the source record. The base value is ACTIVE. - consolidation. Match and merge status of the records. - MATCH_DIRTY. Indicates that the source records are ingressed but haven't undergone the match process. - MATCH_INDEXED. Indicates that match keys are generated for the source records. - MATCHED. Indicates that the source records matched other records based on the match configuration, and are ready for merging. - CONSOLIDATION PENDING. Indicates that the source records haven't undergone the match process because the records were ingressed with the business IDs of existing records. - CONSOLIDATION INDEXED. Indicates that match keys are generated for the source records ingressed with the business IDs of existing records. - CONSOLIDATED. Indicates that the source records are merged either manually or automatically. - NOT READY FOR MATCH. Indicates that you've excluded the source records from participating in the match process. - searchIndex. Indicates that the record is in the SEARCH_DIRTY state and is not searchable. Currently, source records aren't searchable. - validation. Indicates the validation status of the record. - PENDING. Indicates that the record isn't yet validated. - PASSED. Indicates that the record is validated and has no errors. - FAILED. Indicates that the record is validated and has validation and data quality errors.
dataEnhancementRule	Object	Object that contains data enrichment and validation details. The object contains the fail parameter, which is an array of failed data enhancement rules. The array contains the following parameters: - provider. For internal use only. - rule. Array that contains details about the failed data enhancement rule. The array contains the following parameters: - id. Internal ID of the failed rule. - dts. Array that contains the trust score downgrades. The array contains the following parameters: - dtsp. The trust score downgrade percentage that was applied to the fields. - fieldRef. Array that contains the fields to which the data enrichment rule was applied.

Step 3: Unmerge source records and discard the patch records

Unmerge source records from the master record. To ensure that records aren't related to any other records, delete all the relationships and patch records associated with the master record.

To unmerge source records and permanently delete all the relationships, submit a POST request with the following URI:

```
<baseApiURL>/business-entity/public/api/v1/entity-group/<businessEntity>/<businessId>?
_groupingForRemoved=NONE&_groupingForRemains=NONE&_keepRelsWith=NONE
```

Note: To ensure that the unmerge operation is successful, add up to 10 records in the request body.

Parameter	Type	Description
businessEntity	String	Internal ID of the business entity that the records belong to.
businessId	String	Unique identifier of the master record.
_keepRelsWith=NONE	String	Permanently deletes all the relationships that are created from the user interface for the master record.
_groupingForRemoved=NONE	String	Unmerges source records from the master record without creating master records for them and deletes patch records associated with source records.
_groupingForRemains=NONE	String	Source records that aren't selected for anonymization continue to be associated with the master record.

The response is in the JSON format.

Request body

To unmerge records, use a combination of the sourcePKey and sourceSystem parameters in the request body.

To unmerge records, use the following parameters in the request body:

Parameter	Type	Description
sourcePKey	String	The primary key of a source record.
sourceSystem	String	Internal ID of the source system to which the record belongs.

Request response

The request response indicates whether a data steward must approve the unmerge action.

The following table lists the response parameter:

Parameter	Type	Description
approvalRequired	Boolean	Indicates whether approval workflow is configured. If the response is true, approval workflow is configured. If the response is false, approval workflow is not configured.

Step 4: Anonymize a source record

Use the Update Source Record Field API to anonymize the identified field values in a source record.

For example, replace student name and student number with values that prevent direct identification.

Type of data	Student name	Student number
Orginal data	Joe Smith	5690265
Anonymized data	Student1	xxxxxxx

To update a source record, submit a PATCH request with the following URI:

```
PATCH <baseApiURL>/business-entity/public/api/v1/entity-xref/<businessEntity>/<sourceSystem>/
<sourcePKey>[?_forceUpdate=true|false][&_resolveCrosswalk=true|false][&notReadyForMatch=true|false]
```

You can use the following parameters in the request:

Parameter	Description
businessEntity	Internal ID of the business entity for which you want to update the source record.
sourceSystem	Internal ID of the source system to which the source record belongs.
sourcePKey	The primary key of the source record.
_forceUpdate	Optional. Specifies whether to force update existing records irrespective of their source last updated dates. Default is false.
_resolveCrosswalk	Optional. Indicates whether to standardize picklist values based on the source system configuration. To standardize the picklist values, set to true. If set to true, ensure that the picklist values belong to a code list that's part of a crosswalk. Default is false. For more information about standardizing picklist values, see *Define Source Systems*.
notReadyForMatch	Optional. Specifies whether a source record can participate in the match process. Default is false.

You can use the following parameters in the request body:

Parameter	Description
op	The operator that indicates the type of update. You can specify the following operators: - add. Adds new data to the record. Use the add operator when you add a root field or a field group to a record. - replace. Replaces the existing data. Use the replace operator when you update a root field or a field group of a record. - remove. Removes the data from the source record. - setSourceLastUpdateDate. Sets the last updated date for a root or a field group of a source record.
path	The internal ID of the field you want to update. **Note:** If the field contains multiple values, specify the name and the internal ID of the field. For example, the Postal Address field contains multiple values.
value	Contains the values that you want to use to update the source record.

The response is in the JSON format. The PATCH response returns HTTP 200 success code. When you submit a REST API request to update a source record, MDM SaaS verifies your existing user role permissions and the approval workflow configuration. The response indicates whether a data steward must approve the source records you updated.

The following request force updates the student name, and the student number in a source record:

```
PATCH  <baseApiUrl>/business-entity/public/api/v1/entity-xref/c360.person/c360.default.system/
pkey3132

[
    { "op": "replace", "path": "StudentName", "value": "Student1" },
    { "op": "replace", "path": "StudentNumber", "value": "xxxx" }

]
```

Step 5: Anonymize the history of a master record

Use the Anonymize History of Master Record API to anonymize the history of a master record, ensuring that sensitive information is protected and complies with privacy regulations. You can apply anonymization to remove personally identifiable information (PII) from the history of master records while preserving the integrity of data for analysis and reporting.

The Anonymize History of Master Record API anonymizes the historical data associated with a master record based on the source record details that you provide. The API finds data from a source record in the history of the master record and anonymizes that data.

Note: Effective in the May 2025 release, the ability to anonymize the historical data of a master record is available for preview.

Preview functionality is supported for evaluation purposes but is unwarranted and is not supported in production environments or any environment that you plan to push to production. Informatica intends to include the preview functionality in an upcoming release for production use, but might choose not to in accordance with changing market or technical circumstances. For more information, contact Informatica Global Customer Support.

POST request

To anonymize the history of a master record, submit a POST request with the following URI:

```
POST <baseApiUrl>/business-entity/public/api/v1/entity-history/<businessEntity>/anonymize
```

The POST request contains the following parameters:

Parameter	Description
businessEntity	Internal ID of the business entity to which the master record that you want to anonymize belongs.

Request body

You can use the following parameters in the request body:

Parameter	Type	Description
sourceSystem	String	Internal ID of the source system to which the source record belongs. The source record is associated with the history of the master record.
sourcePKey	String	The primary key of the source record that's associated with the master record.
fields	String	The field values that you want to use to anonymize the history of a master record. Include a field name and the anonymized value.
redoAnonymizedBefore: <Time stamp>	Epoch	Optional. Indicates that you are re-anonymizing the source record. It can be new values that aren't anonymized or already anonymized field values. The history of master records anonymized before the specified timestamp are re-anonymized. Specify the current timestamp in the epoch format.

POST response

The response is in the JSON format. The POST response returns HTTP 204 No Content.

POST example

The following sample request re-anonymizes the first name and last name in the history of a master record associated with the specified source record:

```
POST <baseApiUrl>/business-entity/public/api/v1/entity-history/c360.person/anonymize
{
  "sourceSystem": "demo.system.default",
  "sourcePKey": "001",
  "fields": {
    "firstName": "XXX",
    "lastName": "XXX"
  }
 "redoAnonymizedBefore": 1721427778000
}
```

The first name and last name values updated before the provided timestamp are anonymized.

Post-anonymization tasks

Consider the following guidelines and best practices post-anonymization:

- Optionally, merge the anonymized source records with their master records. For more information about merging records, see *Business 360 REST API Reference*.
- To prevent records from participating in match and merge process, delete the anonymized source records and all the other source records that contribute values to the master record. For more information about deleting source records, see *Business 360 REST API Reference*.
- Optionally, you can run egress jobs to ensure that exported data is also anonymized. For more information about egress jobs, see *Define Jobs*.

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